

ISLAMIC INVADERS OF INDIA

Bin Qasim • Ghaznavi • Ghori

From the first Arab raid on Sindh to the founding of the Delhi Sultanate by Qutub-ud-din Aibak

- Headings & Definitions ● Explanations ● Highlighter = Key Facts 🎯 Exam Tip ✗ Common Mistake
🧠 Memory Trick

StudyPlanner



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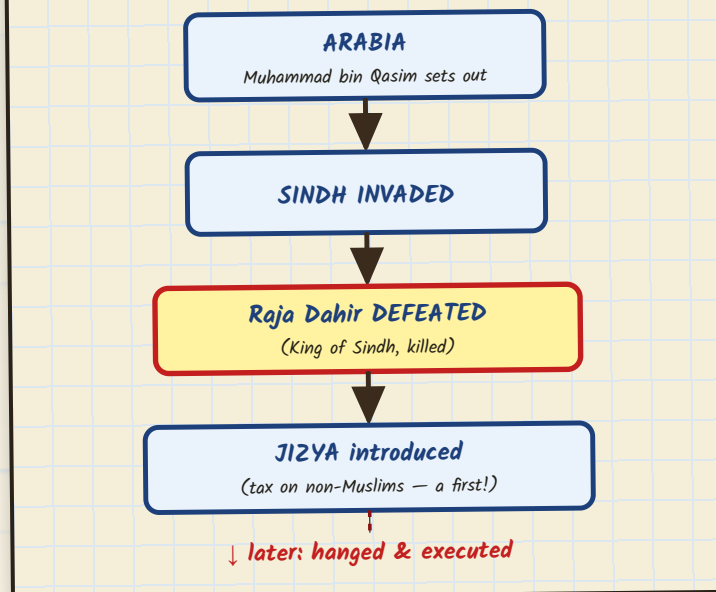


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MUHAMMAD BIN QASIM — THE FIRST ISLAMIC INVADER

Our medieval history begins with the Islamic invasion of India. The very first Islamic invader was Muhammad bin Qasim.

🌍 Fig 1: Bin Qasim's Invasion Trail



Where From & Whom Did He Defeat?

- Muhammad bin Qasim was an Arab invader — he came from Arabia
- He invaded the Sindh province, located in present-day Pakistan

- The ruler of Sindh, **Raja Dahir** (King Dahir), was defeated and killed by him

✗ Common Mistake

Muhammad bin Qasim is *not* a "Turk" invader — he was an **Arab**, from Arabia! The first **Turk** invader was Mahmud of Ghaznavi — coming up next!



🧠 Memory Trick

Three "firsts" for Bin Qasim: 1st Islamic invader of India, 1st to attack Sindh, 1st to introduce the Jizya!

Jizya — Introduced for the First Time

It is believed that Muhammad bin Qasim introduced the **Jizya** for the first time — the tax paid by non-Muslims.

🎯 Exam Tip

Jizya = tax on non-Muslims. Remember: Bin Qasim is credited as the **FIRST** to introduce it in India.

📖 His End — the story of Dahir's daughters (tap to expand) ▼



Legend has it: Raja Dahir's own daughters brought down his conqueror — accused before the Sultan of Arabia, Muhammad bin Qasim was hanged and executed!

Quick Recap Chain



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MAHMUD OF GHAZNAVI — THE FIRST TURK INVADER

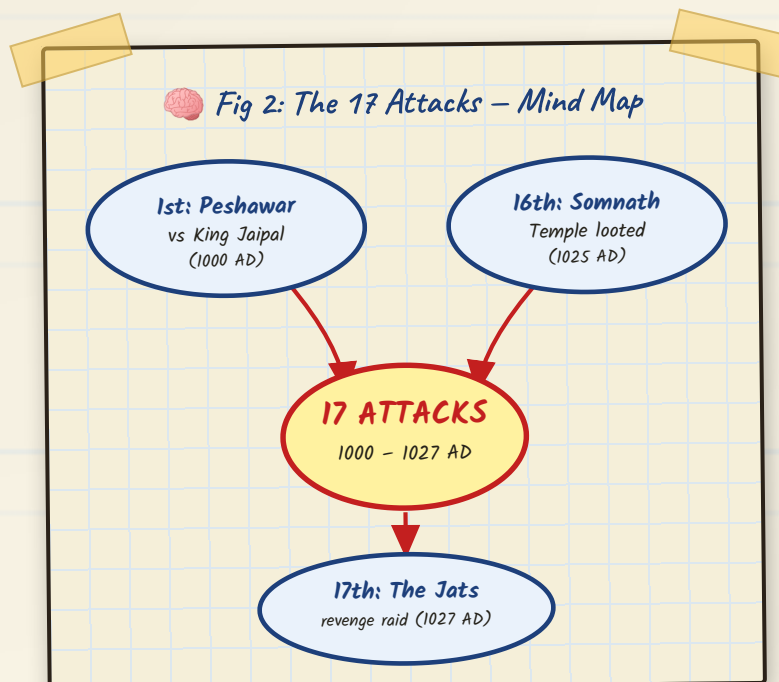
The second Islamic invader — and the first Turk invader — was Mahmud of Ghaznavi.

✗ Common Mistake

"Turk" here does *not* mean someone from Turkey — it means someone from Turkmenistan (Central Asia)!

17 Attacks on India

Mahmud of Ghaznavi attacked India a total of 17 times. Of these, the 1st, 16th, and 17th attacks matter most for exams.



1st Attack — Battle of Peshawar

- His first attack took place in 1000 AD
- It is known as the Battle of Peshawar
- Fought against King Jaipal — Jaipal was very badly defeated
- It is believed Jaipal committed suicide after this defeat
- Fun fact: Peshawar was formerly known as Purushpura

📌 Fun Fact

Peshawar — the site of Ghaznavi's very first attack — was earlier called **Purushpura**!

16th & 17th Attacks – Somnath & the Jats

- 16th attack: on the **Somnath Temple**, in **1025 AD** — he looted and plundered the temple's wealth
- ★ ● 17th (and last) attack: in **1027 AD**, against the **Jats** — revenge, since the Jats troubled him while he carried the looted Somnath wealth back
- Main motive throughout: **plunder** (to fund and expand his empire back home), not settling down to rule India



Understand it like this...

Ghaznavi's raids were smash-and-grab missions, not conquest-and-settle. He looted wealth — like Somnath's treasures — to expand his empire on the Arab/Central-Asian side, never to rule India directly!



Memory Trick

1st fought a **KING** (Jaipal, Peshawar) → 16th looted a **TEMPLE** (Somnath) → 17th chased the **JATS** (revenge) — 1-King, 16-Temple, 17-Jats!



Timeline of the Key Attacks

- **1000 AD**
Battle of Peshawar — defeats King Jaipal (his 1st attack).
- **1025 AD**
16th attack — loots the Somnath Temple.
- **1027 AD**
17th & last attack — against the Jats, in revenge.



17 TOTAL invasions — but only these 3 matter most for exams!



Exam Tip

Order matters: **1st** (Peshawar, Jaipal) → **16th** (Somnath) → **17th** (Jats, last). Don't swap 16th and 17th!

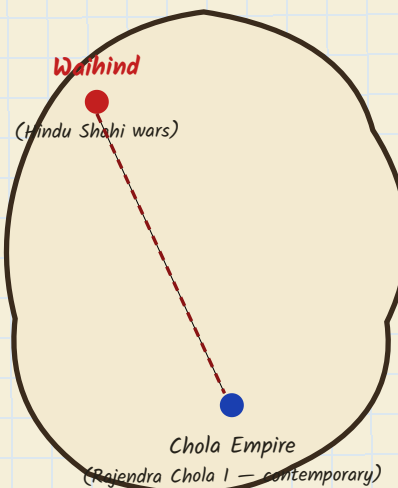


GHAZNAVI'S WARS, BOOKS + DEATH

Battles of Waihind – vs the Hindu Shahi Dynasty

Mahmud of Ghaznavi fought a series of wars against the Hindu Shahi Dynasty — together known as the Battles of Waihind. (King Jaipal, defeated at Peshawar, belonged to this very Hindu Shahi Dynasty.)

Fig 3: Ghaznavi's Rivals & Contemporaries



Contemporary Rulers

Mahmud of Ghaznavi was a contemporary of the Chola Dynasty rulers of South India — specifically Rajendra Chola I.

Hindu Shahi Dynasty & Waihind — background (tap to expand) ▼

Books Written During His Time

Two important books were written during Mahmud of Ghaznavi's era — not written by him, but by scholars of his time.

Text	Author	Note
Shahnama	Ferdowsi	Persian epic — Ghaznavi's era
Tahqiq-e-Hind (Kitab-ul-Hind)	Al-Biruni	Study of India — Ghaznavi's era
Badshahnama	Abdul Hamid Lahori	✗ NOT this era — later Mughal text!

✗ Common Mistake

Don't confuse **Shahnama** (Ferdowsi, Ghaznavi's era) with **Badshahnama** (Abdul Hamid Lahori, a much later Mughal-era book)! Similar-sounding names, completely different books.

📖 Two courts, two books: Ferdowsi's *Shahnama* immortalized Persia's kings; Al-Biruni's *Kitab-ul-Hind* studied India itself — both flourished in Ghaznavi's time.

🎯 Exam Tip

Tahqiq-e-Hind = Kitab-ul-Hind = the **same book**, by Al-Biruni. Two names, one author!

Death

Mahmud of Ghaznavi died in **1030 AD**.

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MUHAMMAD GHORI — THE 3RD ISLAMIC INVADER

The third Islamic invader — also called the **second Turk invader** — was **Muhammad Ghori**. This is where the foundation of the **Delhi Sultanate** begins — very important for

Early Campaigns – Multan & Gujarat

Year	Place	Result
1175 AD	Multan	First attack — captured
1178 AD	Gujarat	Defeated by Naiki Devi!

- 1175 AD — Ghori's first attack, on the **Multan** region (in present-day Pakistan)
- 1178 AD — attacked Gujarat, then ruled by **Mularaja II** and **Bhima II**, whose mother (and regent) was **Naiki Devi**
- Ghori was **defeated** in Gujarat itself, by Naiki Devi

 **Memory Trick**

A **QUEEN** stopped Ghori before Prithviraj ever fought him — Naiki Devi, Gujarat, 1178!

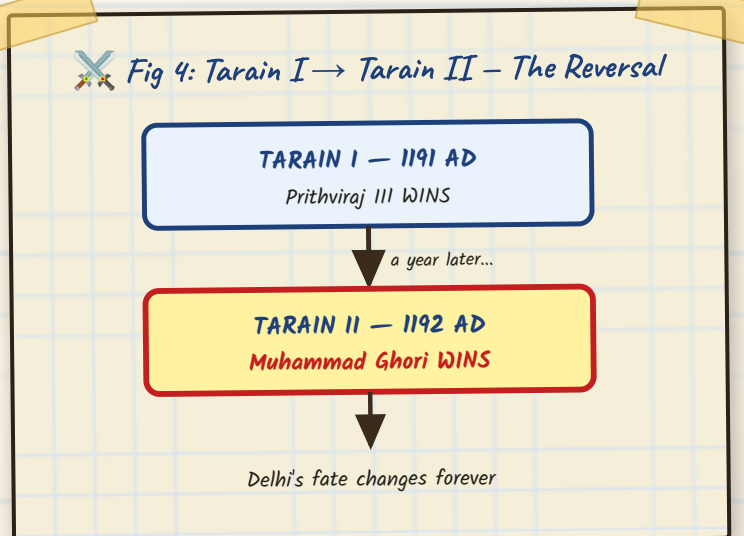
 Delhi before the Chauhans — the Tomar Dynasty (tap to expand) ▼

Battles of Tarain (near Delhi)

Tarain lies in the Terai region near Delhi — the same "Terai/Tarai plains" you'll meet again in geography, and later with Babur's battles!

There were **two** Battles of Tarain, fought between Muhammad Ghori and **Prithviraj III** (Prithviraj Chauhan):

 Fig 4: Tarain I → Tarain II — The Reversal





Multan '75 ✓



Gujarat '78 ✗



Tarain I '91 ✗



Tarain II '92 ✓



Exam Tip

Tarain I (1191) = Prithviraj wins. Tarain II (1192) = Ghori wins. The **SECOND** battle changed everything!



Memory Trick

Before Chauhans: TOMAR dynasty ruled Delhi (founder: Anangpal Tomar). Chauhans came next, and lost Delhi to Ghori in Tarain II (1192).

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CHANDAWAR, THE SLAVES + THE SULTANATE

Battle of Chandawar (1194 AD)

After Tarain, Ghori fought and defeated Jaichand at the Battle of Chandawar in 1194 AD. Jaichand ruled Chandawar (Kannauj), and belonged to the Gahadavala Dynasty.



Sanyogita, Prithviraj Raso & the Jaichand legend (tap to expand) ▼



Jaichand invited Ghori to defeat his rival Prithviraj – but the invader Ghori turned around and defeated Jaichand as well!



Common Mistake

The Sanyogita-Prithviraj romance comes from the **Prithviraj Raso** – some historians doubt its historical accuracy. Don't present it as an undisputed fact in your answers!

Ghori's Return & His Four Slaves

After Chandawar, Ghorī returned home. His most important legacy in India came through his **four slaves**:

Slave	Known For
Yalduz (Tajuddin Yildiz)	One of Ghorī's four trusted slaves
Qabacha (Nasiruddin Qabacha)	One of Ghorī's four trusted slaves
Bakhtiyar Khilji	Destroyed Nalanda University
Qutub-ud-din Aibak	Ascended the throne of Delhi!

✗ Common Mistake

Bakhtiyar Khilji (Ghorī's slave, destroyed Nalanda) is *not* the same person as **Alauddin Khilji** (a much later, unrelated Delhi Sultan)! Similar surname, different centuries.

Nalanda & Vikramshila – Universities Lost & Built

- **Bakhtiyar Khilji** is remembered for destroying **Nalanda University**
- Nalanda was built by **Kumar Gupta** (of the Gupta Dynasty)
- **Vikramshila** (another great university) was built by rulers of the **Pala Dynasty**

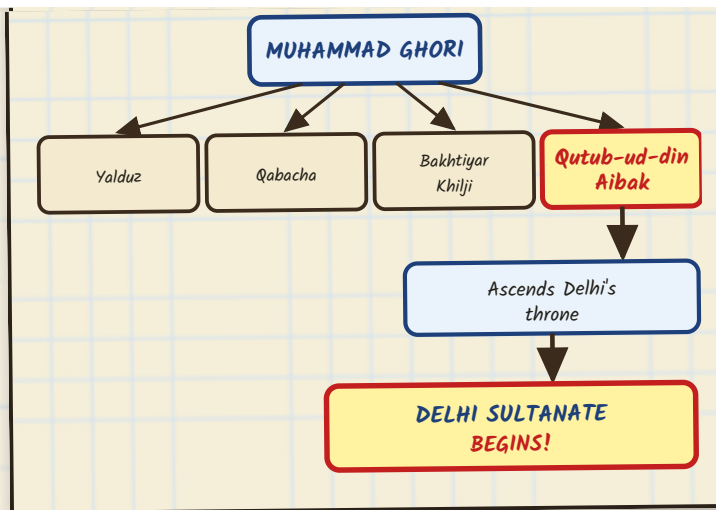
📌 Fun Fact

Nalanda (Gupta-built) and Vikramshila (Pala-built) were two of ancient India's greatest universities. Bakhtiyar Khilji's raid on Nalanda was a huge loss for Indian learning.

Qutub-ud-din Aibak Found the Delhi Sultanate

Of Ghorī's four slaves, **Qutub-ud-din Aibak** was the most loyal and capable. He ascended the throne of Delhi and began to rule — laying the **foundation of the Delhi Sultanate**.

👑 Fig 5: From Ghorī's Slave to Delhi's Sultan



Timeline: From Tarain II to the Sultanate

- **1192 AD**
Ghori wins Tarain II, defeats Prithviraj III.
- **1194 AD**
Ghori defeats Jaichand at Chandawar.
- Ghori returns home. His slave **Qutub-ud-din Aibak** ascends Delhi's throne.



Qutub-ud-din Aibak becomes the first ruler of the Delhi Sultanate!



Exam Tip

Remember the chain: Tarain II (1192) → Chandawar (1194) → Ghori returns → Aibak ascends → Delhi Sultanate begins!

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Print Notes